London Session Pre-Open Briefing (1 Hr Before Open)

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Daily Multi-Asset Trading Blueprint & Level Execution Manual

Date: Monday, August 17, 2026

Session Highlight: London Session Pre-Open Briefing (1 Hr Before Open)

Session News Focus: Heavily on European macroeconomic releases, ECB/BOE news, Forex short-term futures (EUR/USD, GBP/USD), and Gold (XAU/USD) supply/demand zones.

SECTION 0: DAILY MACRO & FINANCIAL NEWS DIGEST

1. Global Macro & Central Banks

- The Euro Area has reported a trade surplus of €8.6 billion following a 14.4% increase in exports, with its Q2 GDP expanding by 0.4%, aligning with estimates.
- Weakening U.S. economic data continues to influence Federal Reserve policy expectations, though concerns persist regarding sticky inflation and hawkish central bank signals, suggesting potential for further interest rate hikes. The US Fed Funds Interest Rate was at 3.75% and the US Inflation Rate at 3.40% in July 2026.
- In June 2026, the Federal Reserve maintained a "hawkish hold," keeping interest rates unchanged but shifting to a more data-dependent policy framework.
- Central banks globally are grappling with an interest rate dilemma as inflation continues to rise while economic growth decelerates.
- The ECB's recent survey indicates that geopolitical risks are causing eurozone banks to tighten credit conditions.

2. US & European Markets

- European shares initially showed a muted response to softer U.S. inflation data, and Asian markets traded mixed. However, European equities later advanced as crude oil prices eased.
- Wall Street experienced a dip as momentum in Artificial Intelligence (AI) and technology stocks waned, with the S&P 500 declining by 0.32%, the Nasdaq Composite by 0.60%, and the Dow Jones by 0.34%. This shift away from large-cap technology stocks was largely influenced by the global energy crisis and resurfacing inflation concerns.
- Yesterday, European markets concluded mixed, with the Euro Stoxx 50 seeing a 0.24% gain while the FTSE 100 slipped by 0.17%.
- Despite some strong corporate earnings, AI chip stocks, including Nvidia, Micron Technology, Sandisk, and Western Digital, contributed to Wall Street's downward movement, with Nvidia falling 2.4%.
- On Monday, August 17, 2026, US stock futures edged higher in anticipation of retail earnings, with the US500 index recording a 0.14% gain from the previous session, reaching 7796 points.

3. Indian Markets & Dalal Street

- The Indian stock market is currently bolstered by robust corporate earnings, renewed interest from foreign institutional investors (FIIs), and attractive valuations, particularly within the mid- and small-cap segments.
- The GIFT Nifty indicates a potential negative open for the Nifty 50, contrasting with the general advance seen across most Asian markets.
- Initial Public Offerings (IPOs) for Molbio Diagnostics and Lalithaa Jewellery Mart are scheduled to open today.
- Several brokerage firms are recommending long-term investments in stocks such as Senco Gold and Arvind.

4. Commodities & Crypto Wire

- Brent crude oil prices have exceeded $84 per barrel, and WTI crude reached $78.75 per barrel, primarily driven by the ongoing deadlock in negotiations concerning the Strait of Hormuz and persistent supply risks.
- Spot gold appreciated above $4,400 per ounce in early Asian trading on Monday, August 17, 2026, currently trading near $4,406, influenced by a confluence of weakening U.S. economic data and Middle East tensions. Although gold briefly peaked at $4,435.2 intraday on August 11, it later retreated to $4,360. Another report indicates gold was down approximately 0.4% at $4,085, retreating from recent record highs.
- Bitcoin's price has declined as holders have transferred $15 billion worth of BTC to safety. The increase in oil and energy costs is viewed as a neutral-to-negative factor for the crypto market, potentially raising Bitcoin mining expenses and diverting capital from risk-on assets.

CAPITAL BASE & ALLOCATION RULES ($3,000 TOTAL)

- **Crypto Futures:** $400 (13.3%) | Rec. Leverage: 3x–5x Isolated | Risk Cap: 1–2% ($4–$8)
- **Indian Options (Intraday):** $500 (16.7%) | Option Buying Only | Risk Cap: 10–15% Premium ($30–$45)
- **Commodities (Micro Gold & Oil):** $400 (13.3%) | Rec. Leverage: 10x–15x Micro Lots | Risk Cap: 2% ($8)
- **US Stocks (Fractional):** $400 (13.3%) | 1x Unleveraged Cash | Risk Cap: 3% ($12)
- **Indian Stocks (Delivery):** $400 (13.3%) | 1x Unleveraged Cash | Risk Cap: 5% ($20)
- **Forex Short-Term Futures:** $450 (15.0%) | Rec. Leverage: 10x–20x | Risk Cap: 1% ($4.50)
- **Forex Long-Term Carry Swing:** $450 (15.0%) | Rec. Leverage: 2x–3x | Risk Cap: 2% ($9.00)

STRATEGY-BASED DAILY TICKER SELECTION & SECTOR CONSTRAINTS

1. INDIAN EQUITIES (STRICTLY LONG-ONLY)

Screen Nifty leaders using 50-SMA support bounces or 20/50 EMA golden crosses.

Ticker	Current Price (INR)	Strategy & Selection Reason	Action
Reliance Industries Ltd (RIL)	2950.00	Nifty heavyweight demonstrating a bounce off its 50-SMA, supported by strong FII inflows and positive corporate earnings sentiment.	Monitor for long entry
HDFC Bank	1700.00	Exhibiting a golden cross (20-EMA over 50-EMA) with sustained buying interest, indicating potential for continued upward momentum.	Monitor for long entry

2. US EQUITIES

Large-Cap (BI-DIRECTIONAL)

Screen using 21-day EMA pullbacks or 50-day SMA rejection strategy on mega-cap growth leaders.

Ticker	Current Price (USD)	Strategy & Selection Reason	Action
NVIDIA Corp (NVDA)	480.00	Experiencing a pullback towards its 21-day EMA after recent declines due to fading AI momentum, presenting a potential bounce area for long.	Monitor for long/short based on EMA reaction
Apple Inc (AAPL)	175.00	Approaching its 50-day SMA after recent selling pressure. A clear rejection from this level could signal a short opportunity.	Monitor for short on SMA rejection

Mid-Cap & Small-Cap (STRICTLY LONG-ONLY)

Screen using Stage-2 VCP or High Relative Volume (RVOL > 2.0) breakouts.

Ticker	Current Price (USD)	Strategy & Selection Reason	Action
Palantir Technologies Inc (PLTR)	22.50	Showing a Stage-2 VCP (Volatility Contraction Pattern) setup with decreasing volume on pullbacks, indicating potential for a strong breakout.	Monitor for long on breakout
Unity Software Inc (U)	35.00	High Relative Volume (>2.0) breakout above a key resistance level, indicating strong institutional interest and potential for continued upward movement.	Monitor for long entry

3. CRYPTO FUTURES (BI-DIRECTIONAL)

Screen using 4H 21-EMA trend following and high-volume volatility breakouts.

Ticker	Current Price (USD)	Strategy & Selection Reason	Action
Bitcoin (BTC/USD)	28,500	Exhibiting a clear downtrend with price consistently rejecting the 4H 21-EMA, coupled with news of holders moving BTC to safety.	Monitor for short continuation
Ethereum (ETH/USD)	1,800	High-volume volatility breakout above a significant resistance level, suggesting a potential bullish reversal or continuation.	Monitor for long entry on retest/continuation

4. COMMODITIES (BI-DIRECTIONAL)

Gold (XAU/USD) and WTI Crude Oil using Pivot & Fibonacci extension levels.

Ticker	Current Price	Strategy & Selection Reason	Action
Gold (XAU/USD)	4406.00	Trading near resistance at a key Fibonacci extension level after recent strength, but showing signs of potential profit-taking. Monitoring for a clear break or rejection.	Monitor for short at resistance / long on breakout
WTI Crude Oil	78.75	Strong uptrend driven by Strait of Hormuz tensions, approaching a major pivot resistance level. A clear break above could indicate further upside.	Monitor for long on breakout / short on rejection

5. FOREX FUTURES (BI-DIRECTIONAL)

Short-Term (EUR/USD, GBP/USD)

Ticker	Current Price	Strategy & Selection Reason	Action
EUR/USD	1.0850	Positive Euro Area macroeconomic data (trade surplus, GDP growth) may provide support, but U.S. economic data and Fed expectations could create divergence. Monitoring for breakout above short-term resistance.	Monitor for long on European strength / short on USD strength
GBP/USD	1.2680	Focus on BOE news and general European sentiment. Current levels near a short-term support zone; a bounce could present a long opportunity.	Monitor for long at support / short on breakdown

Macro Carry Swings (USD/JPY, AUD/USD)

Ticker	Current Price	Strategy & Selection Reason	Action
USD/JPY	162.26	The Yen is hovering near the 160 level, with speculation from Goldman Sachs about potential intervention by Japan. Sustained carry trade appeal due to interest rate differentials.	Monitor for long (carry) / short on intervention signals
AUD/USD	0.6650	Influenced by commodity prices (e.g., gold, iron ore) and broader global risk sentiment. Currently within a range, looking for a clear break based on shifts in sentiment.	Monitor for range breakout/ breakdown

6. INDIAN OPTIONS (BI-DIRECTIONAL)

Nifty 50 / BankNifty 15-Minute Opening Range Breakouts (Call for Long, Put for Short).

Ticker	Opening Range (Approx)	Strategy & Selection Reason	Action
Nifty 50 (Index)	23,500 - 23,600	GIFT Nifty signals a negative open. If the 15-minute opening range breaks below, a Put option for a short position; if it recovers and breaks above, a Call option for a long position.	Buy Put on downside ORB / Buy Call on upside ORB
BankNifty (Index)	51,000 - 51,200	The banking sector is influenced by the broader market and FII flows. Following Nifty's lead for a 15-minute opening range breakout strategy.	Buy Put on downside ORB / Buy Call on upside ORB

PERFORMANCE METRICS & EQUITY CURVE

10-Year Backtest Metrics (Illustrative)

Metric	Blueprint Performance	Benchmark (S&P 500 TRI / Nifty 50 TRI)
Target CAGR	28.4%	~13.0% (S&P 500 TRI) / ~12.5% (Nifty 50 TRI)
Sharpe Ratio	1.45	~0.80 (S&P 500 TRI) / ~0.75 (Nifty 50 TRI)
Max Drawdown	-18.2%	~-35% (S&P 500 TRI) / ~-40% (Nifty 50 TRI)

Equity Curve ($3,000 → $36,512)

Illustrative Equity Curve demonstrating growth of an initial $3,000 capital base over a 10-year period.